



# TravelGuard AI

**Your card should not stop working when you land.**

An AI decision layer for banks that reads live mobile-network signals to confirm the customer is genuinely abroad — so real travellers get approved, and fraud still gets blocked.

01 Verify with the network → 02 Score the risk with AI → 03 Approve in milliseconds

FinTech

Tourism

Digital Identity & Fraud Prevention

AI Agents

CAMARA APIs



## 1 The Story

A problem that happens every single day, to millions of travellers.

**Ahmed, a tourist from Germany, lands in Marrakech for his vacation.**

After a long flight, he walks into a café to buy a coffee. He taps his bank card.

✕ TRANSACTION DECLINED

His bank has automatically blocked the card, because the payment came from another country.

### What Ahmed has to do next

- Call international customer support
- Wait on hold for verification
- Explain that he is simply travelling
- Wait for the card to be unblocked

His vacation starts with frustration instead of enjoying Morocco.

### And this is not an isolated case

*"Bank blocked my card AGAIN while traveling between countries."*

The traveller had already informed his bank before departure. The card was blocked anyway. His conclusion was simple:

*"Is there literally any payment solution that just works everywhere?"*

**SOURCE** Real user report, r/digitalnomad — **"Bank blocked my card again while traveling"**  
[reddit.com/r/digitalnomad/comments/1pu6ghr/bank\\_blocked\\_my\\_card\\_again\\_while\\_traveling/](https://www.reddit.com/r/digitalnomad/comments/1pu6ghr/bank_blocked_my_card_again_while_traveling/)

### Who is affected

Tourists Business travellers Digital nomads International students Pilgrims & seasonal travellers Expatriate workers

### The moment that decides everything

Every one of these blocks comes down to a single question the bank cannot currently answer with confidence:

#### Where?

Is the cardholder actually in the country where the payment is being made?

#### Who?

Is the person holding the device really the legitimate customer?

#### Normal?

Does this behaviour match what this specific customer usually does?

Today the bank guesses. TravelGuard AI lets it ask the network instead.

## 2 The Problem

Fraud systems protect customers — but they also punish honest ones.

Banks use fraud detection systems to protect their customers. Unfortunately, most of these systems still rely heavily on **static rules**.



These rules do stop fraud. But they also block a large number of completely legitimate customers — and both sides pay the price.

### Cost for customers

- Card blocked abroad, with no warning
- Unable to pay hotels, restaurants or transport
- Stress and lost time during travel
- Loss of trust in the bank

### Cost for banks

- High false-positive rate
- Thousands of inbound support calls
- Manual investigation workload
- Higher operational cost
- Lower customer satisfaction and retention

### The workaround does not work either

Travel notices are the current answer to this problem. In practice customers forget to set them, the notice does not cover an unplanned stop, or the card is blocked anyway — which is exactly what happened in the case above. The bank is still working from a declaration, not from evidence.

## 3 Why Current Systems Fail

Signals are evaluated in isolation, not as context.

Today's fraud engines look at each signal independently:

Location = Morocco

Roaming = True

SIM Swap = No

Each one is treated as a separate box to tick. The system then struggles whenever:

- Information is **incomplete**
- Signals **conflict** with each other

- **Context** matters more than the raw value
- Customer behaviour is **unique**

**The core failure:** fraud detection ends up as a rigid rule engine instead of an intelligent decision system. A true or false answer per signal can never express “this is unusual, but it is still almost certainly Ahmed.”

## 4 Our Solution

TravelGuard AI — an AI-powered decision intelligence layer for banks.

We do not replace the bank's fraud engine. We **enhance** it — as a B2B layer that plugs into the existing decision flow and returns a smarter answer.

1 **Bank** — transaction arrives, fraud engine calls TravelGuard instead of auto-blocking

2 **TravelGuard AI** — decision intelligence layer

3 **CAMARA APIs** — trusted, real-time telecom signals from the network

4 **AI Risk Engine** — signal fusion, behavioural baseline, risk scoring

5 **Decision + Explanation** — approve / step-up / reject, with an audit-ready reason

6 **Bank** — executes the decision in milliseconds

## 5 How It Works

Telecom truth, combined with banking context.

### CAMARA

#### Device Location

Is the device physically where the payment is happening?

### CAMARA

#### Roaming Status

Is the customer genuinely roaming in that country right now?

### CAMARA

#### SIM Swap

Has the SIM been changed recently — a classic takeover signal?

### CAMARA

#### Number Verification

Does the number truly belong to the authenticated customer?

### BANK CONTEXT

#### Spending behaviour

What is normal for this specific customer?

### BANK CONTEXT

#### Travel history

First trip abroad, or a monthly traveller?

### BANK CONTEXT

#### Transaction amount

Consistent with the customer's usual basket?

### BANK CONTEXT

#### Merchant & country risk

What is the exposure of this merchant category and market?

**The key difference:** instead of returning simple true / false answers, TravelGuard AI reasons over all of these signals together and produces one intelligent, explainable decision.

## 6 Core AI Features

Why this is genuine AI decisioning, not an API wrapper.

### Intelligent risk scoring

Multiple signals are combined into a single dynamic risk score, rather than a chain of hard gates.

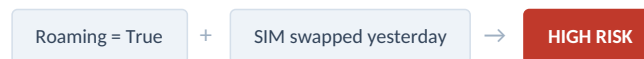
|     |                        |                                                                      |
|-----|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 12% | Approve                | Low risk — payment goes through instantly, customer notices nothing. |
| 48% | Step-up authentication | Borderline — confirm with the customer before deciding.              |
| 94% | Reject                 | Strong fraud pattern — block and flag for investigation.             |

### Behavioural analysis

The engine learns each customer's normal behaviour. A customer who travels every month should not be treated the same as someone leaving the country for the first time — the same signal carries a different meaning per person.

### Signal fusion

Relationships between signals matter more than any signal alone. The combination is the insight:



Read separately, both values look acceptable. Read together, they describe a textbook SIM-swap takeover.

### Smart decision engine

Beyond approve and reject, TravelGuard AI can recommend step-up authentication, additional verification, or routing to manual review — choosing the least disruptive action that still contains the risk.

### Explainable AI

Every decision is returned with a human-readable justification, so the bank stays fully compliant and auditable.

#### DECISION RECORD

##### Risk score: 18%

- Active roaming detected in destination country
- SIM unchanged for 8 months
- Customer travels to Morocco frequently
- Transaction amount matches previous spending pattern

APPROVE

## 7 Value Proposition

A measurable win on both sides of the transaction.

### For banks

- Fewer false positives
- Better fraud detection accuracy
- Lower support and investigation cost
- Improved customer experience and retention
- Audit-ready, explainable decisions

### For travellers

- The card simply works abroad
- No unnecessary blocking
- Faster, frictionless payments
- Peace of mind while travelling

## 8 Why CAMARA Matters

The network already knows the truth — we let the bank ask it.

Traditional fraud engines rely almost entirely on banking data, and are left guessing about where the customer physically is. TravelGuard AI adds **real-time telecom intelligence** through GSMA Open Gateway CAMARA APIs, allowing the bank to understand whether a customer is genuinely travelling or whether the transaction shows the fingerprints of fraud.

This is a trusted, network-level signal — far harder to spoof than an IP address or GPS coordinate — and it is delivered as an additional layer that significantly improves decision quality **without replacing the bank's existing infrastructure**.

## 9 Vision

Where TravelGuard AI is going.

### OUR MISSION

Protect banks from fraud while ensuring that legitimate travellers can pay anywhere in the world, without unnecessary card blocks.

### What this unlocks for the MENA region

#### Tourism

- Visitors spend without payment friction
- Merchants stop losing sales at the till
- Stronger destination reputation

#### Operators & banks

- New API-based revenue stream for MNOs
- Concrete commercial case for Open Gateway
- Cross-border trust infrastructure for the region

**In one line:** TravelGuard AI is the decision intelligence layer that banks plug into their fraud engine — and CAMARA APIs are the trusted network signals it reasons over.